BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #28 · GENETICS AND FAMILY HISTORY

“I was born defective.”

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Where it often comes from

A birth condition, learning difference, or inherited trait can feel like proof that we came into the world flawed. Comparisons, medical language, and remarks from others can deepen the feeling of being a mistake.

What Scripture teaches

“For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb.” God said to Jeremiah, “Before I formed you in the womb I knew you.” When the disciples asked about a man born blind, Jesus said, “Neither this man nor his parents sinned, but this happened so that the works of God would be displayed in him.” God asked Moses, “Who gave man his mouth? Or who makes the mute or the deaf, the sighted or the blind? Is it not I, the LORD?” You are not a mistake. God knew you, formed you, and has a purpose for you.

> *“For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb”* (Psalm 139:13).

Also see

> “‘Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, and before you were born I set you apart and appointed you as a prophet to the nations.’” (Jeremiah 1:5).

> “Jesus answered, ‘Neither this man nor his parents sinned, but this happened so that the works of God would be displayed in him.’” (John 9:3).

> “And the LORD said to him, ‘Who gave man his mouth? Or who makes the mute or the deaf, the sighted or the blind? Is it not I, the LORD?’” (Exodus 4:11).

> “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:14).

Common self-statements

- I was made wrong.
- I am a mistake.
- Something went wrong with me from the start.
- I was never meant to be.
- God made a bad batch.
- I have always been broken.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either made perfectly or defective.
- Fortune telling: Predicting a life of limitation.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling different and concluding that I was made wrong.
- Labeling: Calling myself defective.

Challenging questions

- Who first called me defective?

- What does God say about how I was formed?
- What gifts do I have that go along with how I was made?
- What purposes might God have for me?
- What would I say to a baby born with my condition?
- Who sees me as valuable?

Truth summary

> God formed me and knew me before I was born. I am not a mistake. My life has purpose, and His works can be displayed in me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- God, Creator
- Guilt/Shame
- Suffering
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I was born defective"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I was born defective." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who first called me defective?
- ☐ What does God say about how I was formed?
- ☐ What gifts do I have that go along with how I was made?
- ☐ What purposes might God have for me?
- ☐ What would I say to a baby born with my condition?
- ☐ Who sees me as valuable?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God knit me together.
- ☐ He knew me before I was born.
- ☐ God's works can be displayed in me.
- ☐ God made me as I am.
- ☐ I am not a mistake.
- ☐ My life has purpose.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 139:13**
  "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb."
- ☐ **Jeremiah 1:5**
  "'Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, and before you were born I set you apart and appointed you as a prophet to the nations.'"
- ☐ **John 9:3**
  "Jesus answered, 'Neither this man nor his parents sinned, but this happened so that the works of God would be displayed in him.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Made on purpose: Each week, note one strength or purpose that is part of you.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 139:13 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God formed me and knew me before I was born.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List your gifts. Write what you do well.
- [ ] Name the source. Write who called you defective.
- [ ] Read Psalm 139. Mark each line that speaks of your making.
- [ ] Tell someone. Share how you feel.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I was born defective": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Made on purpose
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I was born defective.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Creator God, You knit me together and knew me before I was born. Heal my sense of being a mistake and show me Your purpose for me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.